HomeoClinic User Guide

Covers releases R0 + R1 + R2 + R3 (milestones M0 + M1 + M2 + M3): "Paper replacement".

This guide is cumulative. Each milestone's guide includes everything from the previous milestones plus the new features. This edition (R3) adds on-screen case taking, follow-up visits, and a live Today screen on top of the patient register (R2) and the setup/lock/backup features (R1). Later editions (R4, R5, ...) will add prescriptions and printing, billing, and the repertory.

HomeoClinic is a fully offline desktop application. It makes no network calls of its own: your patient data never leaves your computer, and everything in this guide works with the internet disconnected.

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1. Installing and opening the app (R0)

Ubuntu / Linux

You received one of these files:

- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`** — portable, no installation. 1. Make it executable: right-click → Properties → Permissions → "Allow executing file as program", or in a terminal run `chmod +x HomeoClinic_*.AppImage`. 2. Double-click it (or run `./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`).
- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`** — installs into the system menu. 1. Install it: `sudo apt install ./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`. 2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from your applications menu.

Windows

1. Run the **`.exe`** (NSIS) or **`.msi`** installer and follow the prompts. The app installs per-user; no administrator rights are required.
2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from the Start menu.

What you should see

- The application window opens within a few seconds.
- On a **brand-new installation**, the app opens the **first-run setup wizard** (see section 2).
- On an **already set-up installation**, the app opens the **lock screen** and asks for your PIN (see section 3).

The main application shell has:

- a **top bar** with a patient search box (press **F2** to focus it) and buttons for Help (**F1**) and Lock (**Ctrl+L**);
- a **left navigation** with Today, Patients, Backup and Settings (some items are disabled until later releases add their screens);
- a **status bar** at the bottom showing the save state, the last backup time, and the licence/trial state.

> In R3 the working areas are: setup, lock, the **Today** home (now with live due/overdue lists), the **Patients** register and search, **case taking** and **follow-up visits** (new in R3), and Backup. Prescriptions, billing and the repertory arrive in later releases.

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2. First-run setup wizard (R1)

The first time you open the app on a new computer, the setup wizard runs automatically. It has at most four short steps and should take only a couple of minutes. The language selector at the top is English for this release.

Step 1 — Doctor profile

Enter your professional details. These print on every prescription and receipt in later releases.

- **Full name** (required)
- **Qualification** (required) — e.g. BHMS, MD(Hom)
- **Registration number** (required)
- **Council** (required) — pick your registering council from the list. The list holds the state and UT homoeopathy boards and councils published by the Ministry of AYUSH, shown as *State: Council name* (for example *Maharashtra: Maharashtra Council of Homoeopathy*), plus the **National Commission for Homoeopathy (National Register)** and the former **Central Council of Homoeopathy (pre-2020)**. If yours is not listed (for example Himachal Pradesh, or a state or UT without its own board), choose **Other (type manually)** and type the council name; it cannot be left empty.

- **Phone** (optional) — asked only here. The same number is saved as both your phone and the clinic phone, so Step 2 does not ask again.
- **Email** (optional)
- **Signature image** and **Clinic logo** (optional)

Click **Next**. Required fields that are empty show an inline message under the field.

Step 2 — Clinic profile

- **Clinic name** (required)
- **Address** (required)
- **Default consultation fee** and **Default follow-up fee** (required) — amounts are shown in Indian number format
- **GSTIN** (optional)
- **Timings** (optional) — two tabs, **Morning** and **Evening**. For each, type the **From** and **To** time the way it reads on a clock: an **hour box (1 to 12)** and a **minute box (00 to 59)**. You never choose AM or PM; it is set for you:
- **Morning** times are AM. A 12 o'clock time, or a To hour smaller than the From hour, is read as PM — so *9:30 to 1:00* becomes **9:30 AM to 1:00 PM**.
- **Evening** times are PM — *5:00 to 8:30* becomes **5:00 PM to 8:30 PM**.
- An hour outside 1–12, minutes outside 00–59, or a To time that is not after the From time shows a message under the box.
- Leave a session empty if the clinic is closed then.

Your timings are saved as, for example, *Morning 9:30 AM-1:00 PM; Evening 5:00 PM-8:30 PM*.

Click **Next**.

Step 3 — Security (PIN and recovery code)

1. **Set a PIN** (4 to 6 digits) and **confirm** it. This PIN protects all your patient data.
2. Choose the **auto-lock** time (how many idle minutes before the app locks itself; default 15).
3. After the PIN is confirmed, the app shows a **one-time recovery code**. - **Write it down or click Print.** It is shown only once. - If you ever forget your PIN, this recovery code is the only way back into your data.
4. Tick **"I have saved my recovery code"** to continue.

> **Keep the recovery code safe and separate from the computer.** There is no way to recover your data without either the PIN or the recovery code — this is what keeps patient data private.

Step 4 — Licence

- Select **Start 30-day free trial**. This release uses a built-in **Development trial**; buying and importing a real licence arrives in a later release.

Click **Finish setup**. The app creates your encrypted database, starts the trial, and opens the **Today** screen, unlocked and ready.

> **Setup must be finished before anything else is available.** The rest of the app cannot be reached until you complete the wizard and start the trial here. **Finish setup** is the only way out of the wizard; there is no shortcut that skips the trial. (If you close the app mid-setup, it reopens on the wizard where you left off.)

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3. Locking and unlocking the app (R1)

Your data sits behind a single PIN entry.

When the app locks

- **On every launch** after setup is complete.
- **Automatically** after the idle time you chose (default 15 minutes).
- **On demand** — press **Ctrl+L** or click the **Lock** button in the top bar at any time.

Unlocking

1. Type your **PIN** and press **Enter** (or click **Unlock**).
2. A correct PIN unlocks immediately and returns you to where you were.
3. A wrong PIN shows an inline message and lets you try again — the app never locks you out or wipes anything for a wrong entry.

Forgot your PIN

1. On the lock screen, click **Forgot PIN?**.
2. Enter the **recovery code** from setup, then set and confirm a **new PIN**.
3. Click **Reset PIN**. You can now unlock with the new PIN.

> Unlocking and recovery happen entirely on your computer — no internet is used or required.

Trial status in the status bar (R1)

The status bar shows your licence state, e.g. **"Licence: Trial — expires (N days left)"**. The days-remaining counts down against a tamper-proof clock: setting the computer's date backwards does **not** extend the trial.

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4. Registering patients (R2)

Open **Patients** from the left navigation, then **New patient** (or press **F4**). This opens the registration form (screen S06).

The registration form

- **Name** (required).
- **Age** (required) **or Date of birth** — entering a date of birth fills the age automatically; otherwise type the age directly (it may be estimated).
- **Sex**, **Mobile**, **Alternate mobile**, **Address**, **City**, **Occupation**, **Blood group**, **Referred by** — all optional.
- **Marital status** (optional) — **Single**, **Married**, **Divorced** or **Widowed**. A value saved by an earlier version still shows.
- A **patient code** (e.g. `HC-000123`) is assigned automatically with your clinic prefix. Codes are **never reused**, even after a patient is deleted and restored.
- Required fields validate inline; fees and money show in Indian number format.

Patient photo (R2)

In the form you can attach a photo two ways:

- **Choose file** — pick an image file from disk.
- **Use webcam** — capture from the computer's default camera. The app asks for camera access; if a camera is unavailable or access is denied, it tells you and you can fall back to a file.

You can **remove**, **retake**, or **swap** the photo (file ↔ webcam) before or after saving — the photo updates with the patient record.

If no photo is added, the app shows a plain **default figure** instead: a male or female outline once **Sex** is chosen. It appears wherever the photo would (the form, the dashboard and the patient lists) and is replaced as soon as you add a real photo.

Duplicate warning

Before saving, if another patient matches on **name + mobile** or **name + date of birth** (including common Indian-name spelling variants), the form shows a **duplicate warning** listing the possible matches. It does not block you — you decide whether it's truly a new patient.

Click **Save**. The new patient is stored and becomes **findable immediately** in search.

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5. Finding patients — global search (R2)

Press **F2** or **Ctrl+K** (or click the top-bar search box) to open the global search overlay from any screen. It finds patients from the first character you type — no need to choose a field.

What it matches

- **Name** — any word prefix, e.g. typing `ram ku` finds "Ramesh Kumar".
- **Patient ID** — full code or just the digits, e.g. `123` finds `HC-000123`.
- **Mobile** — any 4 or more consecutive digits, ignoring `+91` and spaces.
- **City** and **family member name**.
- **Phonetic / spelling variants** of Indian names — e.g. `sarma` finds "Sharma", `laxmi` finds "Lakshmi", `mohd` finds "Mohammad". Exact matches always rank above phonetic ones.

Using it

- Results update as you type and each row shows photo, name, ID, age/sex, mobile, city, last visit and dues.
- Use **Up**/**Down** to move and **Enter** to open the patient's dashboard. **Enter** on an exact ID or mobile match opens that patient directly.
- When the box is empty, your **last 20 opened patients** are shown.
- Search stays fast — results appear in well under a tenth of a second even with tens of thousands of patients.

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6. The patient list and filters (R2)

Open **Patients** to see the full list with a filter panel (screen S05).

- **Filters available now:** last visit older than N days, next follow-up (today / overdue / date range), age range, sex, city, and "has dues". Filters combine together; results are sortable by name, ID, last visit and next follow-up.
- **Export CSV** writes the current filtered, sorted list to a file.
- Some filters (by remedy, diagnosis, potency, case-note text, tags, and saved filters) are shown but **disabled** — they switch on in later releases once more case and prescription data exists.

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7. The patient dashboard (R2)

Clicking a patient (from search or the list) opens their dashboard (screen S07):

- **Demographics banner** — name, code, **age**/sex, mobile, city, referred by, photo (or the default figure) — plus any **allergies / alerts**. The **age updates itself** over time from the date of birth, so it is always current.
- **Family** — linked family members with quick-switch.
- **Take case** — starts the patient's first case (section 8). Once a first case is saved, **New visit** is greyed out ("First case already recorded — use Follow-up") and **Follow-up** is offered instead (section 9), so you cannot start a second first case by mistake.
- **Visits (newest first)** — every saved case and follow-up, latest at the top, with its date and type. The **last visit date** updates as soon as you save.
- **Last prescription** — the medicines (name, potency, dosage) from the most recent prescription table you recorded. This is a **preview** taken from the case notes; real prescriptions arrive in R4.
- **Lab reports & Scans** — every report and scan uploaded for this patient, from any visit, each with a **PDF** or **Image** badge. **Open** shows it; **Delete file** removes the file everywhere (after a confirmation), including from any investigation it was linked to. See section 8 for how reports are uploaded and linked.

A **dues** area and a **Clear dues** button appear as **disabled placeholders** — automatic fee totals and marking dues paid arrive with the billing release (R5).

From the dashboard you can **Edit** the patient, **Export** their record (PDF or JSON), or move them to the **recycle bin**.

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8. Taking a case (R3, new)

From a patient's dashboard, click **Take case** (shortcut **F5**). This opens the case form (screen S08) — the on-screen replacement for the paper case sheet. The whole case is **one running record** that works like a word processor: you type freely, and everything you record drops into the same record as an editable table, in date order.

Complaints and entries

A new case opens empty, with the prompt "*Type the complaint name above, then choose Add new complaint.*"

1. Type the complaint (for example *Headache*) in the **Complaint name** box and click **Add new complaint**. A new complaint section appears with a **numbered heading in bold and underlined**, for example **1. Headache**, and under it today's first entry, headed *Headache — 02-11-2026*. Record everything for today under this entry.
2. When the patient returns for the same complaint, click **Add follow-up entry**. A new entry is added under the same complaint, headed *Headache-follow-up — ,* and you record the follow-up findings there.
3. For a different complaint, type its name and click **Add new complaint** again; it becomes **2. …** and works the same way.

Complaint numbers follow what is on the page: a new complaint always takes the highest number already shown plus one. If you remove complaint 2 and add another, the new one is numbered 2 again. If you click **Add new complaint** without a name, the section is added as *Untitled complaint*; remove it with its × button if it was a mistake.

Removing: every complaint heading and every entry has a × button. The app asks you to confirm first ("Remove this complaint and everything recorded under it? This cannot be undone."). The remaining complaints are renumbered.

Editing: all text, and every cell of every table, can be clicked into and changed at any time (Tab moves between cells). Use the

Bullet list and **Numbered list** buttons to format notes like a word processor. Lists work in your notes, not on a complaint heading.

Record buttons — sections as tables

The buttons above the record each open a small pop-up. When you confirm, the section is added to the **entry you are working in** (the one where your cursor is) as an editable table, under a bullet heading such as **• Vitals** and a separator line:

- **Record vitals** — blood pressure as **two fields, systolic and diastolic**, plus pulse, temperature, SpO2, weight and height; **BMI is worked out for you**.
- **Modalities** — factor, aggravation (<) and amelioration (>).
- **Record family history** — **Maternal** and **Paternal** tabs (one condition per line), shown as a two-column table *Maternal* | *Paternal*.
- **Record physical generals** — appetite, thirst, thermal state, constitution, diet, cravings, aversions, urine, stool, perspiration, **sun aggravation (Yes / No)**, sleep, dreams and sleep position. Anything you leave blank shows as *Not recorded*.
- **Record investigations** — the investigation name, its **status** chosen from a list (**Suggested** or **Submitted**), and notes. See *Lab and scan reports* below.
- **Add prescription** — medicine, potency, dosage and instructions. This is a **preview** saved with the case; real prescriptions and printing arrive in R4.

One table of each kind per entry. The first time you record, say, vitals in an entry, a vitals table is created. Recording vitals again in the **same entry** adds new rows to that **same table** rather than starting another one. The same applies to every kind of table. A **follow-up entry gets its own fresh tables**, so each visit's readings stay together and the earlier visit's tables are never changed.

Family history fills in, not down. If you record only the mother's side and later record the father's side in the same entry, the father's side fills the empty *Paternal* column of the existing rows from the top, so the table stays lined up. New rows are added only if there are more lines than empty cells.

Deleting a row: each data row has a small **−** button at its right-hand end. Click it, confirm, and that row is removed. From the keyboard, put the cursor in the row and press **Ctrl+Shift+Backspace**. The header row cannot be deleted, and deleting the last remaining row removes the whole table.

Lab and scan reports

There are two ways to attach a PDF or image report (ultrasound, CT, blood report and so on):

- **From an investigation:** in **Record investigations**, set the status to **Submitted**. The *Submit a report* pop-up offers **Upload a new report**, or **pick an already-uploaded report** for this patient and click **Link selected report**. A reminder under the upload reads "*Make sure to upload the correct file against the name.*" The report is named automatically as -- so it is easy to match later.
- **Directly:** use **Upload report** in the case's *Lab reports & scans* area, with an optional caption.

Either way the report also appears in the patient's **Lab reports & Scans** list on the dashboard (section 7). In the investigation's row, click **Open** to view the report in one click.

Removing a link versus deleting a file. If a report was linked to the wrong investigation, use **Remove from this investigation**: only the link is removed, and the file stays in Lab reports & Scans. To get rid of the file itself, use **Delete file** (in Lab reports & Scans) or **Remove** next to the report in the case; that permanently deletes it everywhere. Both ask you to confirm.

Reports are stored **encrypted** on your computer and never leave it.

Saving — autosave plus a Save button

- The case **autosaves every 2 seconds and whenever you pause**; the status shows "Saving..." then **"Saved hh:mm"**.
- There is also an explicit **Save** button (or press **Ctrl+S**). Pressing it forces an immediate save and confirms **"Saved"** — for peace of mind that the case is written.
- If the app closes — or the computer crashes — **mid-typing**, reopening the case restores the last saved content (text **and** the inserted tables) with **nothing lost**.
- When you open a saved case, a short loading screen shows until the whole record is ready, so nothing you click can land on a half-loaded page.

> The **"Send to repertory"** action is not shown yet; it switches on when the repertory ships in a later release.

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9. Follow-up visits (R3, new)

Once a patient has a saved first case, the dashboard greys out **New visit** and offers **Follow-up**. Click **Follow-up** to record a return consultation.

A follow-up **reopens the same record** with everything from earlier visits already in it — every complaint, every dated entry, and every table you recorded, **including family history**. Nothing is lost between visits.

1. For each complaint the patient reports on, click inside that complaint and click **Add follow-up entry**. A new entry headed - *follow-up* — is added under it.
2. Record today's findings in that entry with the same buttons as in section
3. The follow-up entry gets **its own fresh tables**, so today's vitals, modalities and so on sit together, while earlier visits' tables stay as they were. Recording the same kind again in this entry adds rows to its table.
4. A new complaint can be added at any visit with **Add new complaint**.

Scheduling the next follow-up. The **Next follow-up** buttons sit at the top of the case screen, on the first case and on every follow-up:

- **7 days**, **15 days**, **1 month** or **2 months** sets the date counted from today. (One month from 31 January is the last day of February.)
- **Custom date** picks any date. Past dates are refused with "*Pick today or a later date.*"
- **Clear** removes the scheduled date.

The header then shows it, for example *Next F/U: 10-11-2026*. On that date the patient appears under **Due today** on the Today screen, and under **Overdue** if the date passes without a visit.

Like the first case, a follow-up **autosaves** and has a **Save** button. After you save, the visit is listed on the patient dashboard under **Visits (newest first)** above the earlier ones, the **last visit date** updates, **Last prescription** shows the newest prescription you recorded, and the Today screen lists the visit under **Registered today**.

> The **progress chart** and formatted **Prescribe / print** actions are not active yet; they switch on in later releases. The prescription table you record is saved as a preview in the meantime.

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10. The Today screen (R3 — now live)

Today is the home screen (press **F3**). From R3 it shows three live lists, driven by the follow-up dates you set:

- **Due today** — patients whose next follow-up falls on today's date.
- **Overdue** — patients whose follow-up date has passed (most overdue first).
- **Registered today** — the visits recorded today.

Each row shows the patient's photo (or default figure), name, code and age/sex; click or press **Enter** to open their dashboard. A patient with a follow-up date appears under **Due today** on that date, then moves to **Overdue** afterwards. Set the date with the **Next follow-up** buttons on the case screen (section 9).

Today also shows the **backup warning banner** when your last good backup is more than 7 days old (see section 11). The licence-renewal reminder becomes live in a later release.

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11. Backing up your data (R1)

Backup becomes available **after** you finish the first-run setup (section 2). Once setup is complete, open **Backup** from the left navigation (or click the "Last backup" chip in the status bar).

Back up now (to a folder or USB drive)

1. Under **Back up now**, choose a destination with **Choose folder...** or **Use USB drive...**.
2. Enter a **backup password** (at least 8 characters). The first time, you also confirm it.
3. Optionally tick **Remember on this PC** so scheduled backups never ask for the password again on this computer.
4. Click **Back up now**.

The app writes a single encrypted file, `*.hcbak`, containing your database and attachments (patients, their photos, and now your cases and visits). After writing, it verifies the file (checksum + decrypt test).

> The backup password is **separate** from your app PIN. You need this password to restore the backup on another computer, so store it safely.

Automatic daily backups

- Automatic daily backup keeps the last **14 daily**, **8 weekly** and **12 monthly** copies, pruning older ones.
- It runs on app close or the first launch of the day and uses your remembered password, so it never interrupts you.

Backup health

- The screen and the status-bar chip show when the **last good backup** ran.
- If the last successful backup is **more than 7 days old**, a warning banner appears prompting you to back up.

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12. Restoring from a backup (R1)

Use this to recover data, or to move to a new computer (install HomeoClinic on the new PC, then restore).

1. On the **Backup** screen, under **Restore from a backup**, click **Choose backup file (.hcbak)...**.
2. **Step 1 — File and password:** select the `.hcbak` file and enter its backup password. A wrong password is refused here and the wizard does not continue.
3. **Step 2 — Preview:** the app shows what the backup contains (counts and dates) **without changing anything yet**.
4. **Step 3 — Confirm:** click **Restore**. Before replacing anything, the app takes a **safety copy of your current data**, then swaps in the restored data. A mistaken restore is therefore recoverable.

After restore, your doctor and clinic profile, **all patients** (with photos) and **all cases and visits** come back.

> Upgrading from an older version keeps your data: installing a new release over an existing one migrates your database automatically and your previous backups still open.
>
> Backup and restore perform **no network calls** and work fully offline.

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13. Quick reference — keyboard shortcuts (R0–R3)

Key	Action
F1	Help
F2 / Ctrl+K	Focus / open global patient search
F3	Today
F4	New patient
F5	Open the case for the open patient: **Take case** for a new patient, **Follow-up** once a first case is saved
Ctrl+S	Save the case now (same as the **Save** button)
Ctrl+Shift+Backspace	Delete the table row the cursor is in (asks to confirm)
Alt+←	Back (up one level: case/follow-up → dashboard → list → Today)
Ctrl+= / Ctrl+-	Zoom text and layout in / out
Ctrl+0	Reset zoom
Ctrl+L	Lock the app now
Up / Down	Move through search results / lists
Enter	Open the selected patient / confirm the current step / unlock
Esc	Close a dialog or the search overlay (never discards data)

> **Back** is always in the **same place** (top of the screen) on every screen, and **Alt+←** does the same from the keyboard. Going back never discards your work — the case is already autosaved.
>
> **Zoom** scales the **whole app** — text, buttons and layout — not just the case record, so you can make everything larger on a big consulting-room screen or smaller to fit more in. Use the zoom buttons at the top or the keys above. The layout **adjusts to the window size at any zoom**: when you maximise, go full-screen, tile the window to one side or drag it smaller, the screen re-flows to fit instead of sitting in a narrow centred column or being cut off.

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14. Privacy and safety notes (R1–R3)

- **Offline only.** HomeoClinic makes no network connections of its own and opens no listening ports.
- **Encrypted at rest.** Your database, patient photos and case records are encrypted; the key is derived from your PIN.
- **Autosave never loses clinical work** — cases and follow-ups save continuously and restore after a crash or an accidental close.
- **No data in logs.** Diagnostic logs never contain patient details.
- **Never lost by accident.** Patients are soft-deleted to a 30-day recycle bin; permanent deletion asks for your PIN.
- **Your data is always recoverable** with your PIN or your recovery code, and always **exportable** (per-patient PDF/JSON, filtered-list CSV, or a full encrypted backup).

Appendix — what is NOT in this release

The following arrive in later milestones and are intentionally absent or shown as **disabled placeholders** in R3: formatted prescriptions and printing (the prescription table you add to the case is saved as a preview only), billing — including the **dues** total and **Clear dues** — and reports, the repertory / Materia Medica and "Send to repertory", per-complaint progress charts, buying/importing a real licence, custom case-template editing, voice dictation and the body diagram, and the appointment book. When those ship, this guide will be extended to cover them.

HomeoClinic User Guide — R3 edition (M0 + M1 + M2 + M3). Generated from `documents/user-guide/HomeoClinic-User-Guide-R3.md`*.*